

Block 1 — Life Span: Prenatal · Infancy · Early Childhood

Issues, Areas & Approaches 10M

Three Issues

Continuity vs. Discontinuity — smooth accumulation vs. age-specific stages.

Stability vs. Change — does a trait stay stable or change?

Nature vs. Nurture — today: interaction of both.

Baltes' 11 Characteristics

Lifelong · Multidimensional · Multidirectional · **Plasticity** · Contextual · Multidisciplinary ·

Growth/Maintenance/Regulation · Embedded in History · **Normative age-graded** ·

Normative history-graded · **Non-normative events**.

Four Areas & Forces

Areas: Physical · Psychological/Cognitive · Social/Emotional · Sexuality/Gender.

Forces: Biological · Psychological · Socio-cultural · Life cycle.

Cephalocaudal (head→foot) · **Proximodistal** (centre→extremities).

Stages (Tennant & Pogson, 1995)

Childhood (0–20) · Early adulthood (17–45) · Middle adulthood (40–65) · Late adulthood (60+).

Research Methods 3M

Longitudinal (same individual over time) · **Cross-sectional** (different ages, same time) ·

Sequential (combines both = "best") · **Time-lag** (different ages, different years).

Obstacles: Representative sample · Rapport · Methodology · Accuracy · Ethics.

Prenatal Development 10M

Three Periods

Zygote (fertilisation→2 wks): 46 chromosomes, divides < 2 days.

Embryo (2 wks→2 months): tissue differentiation; **critical period** for teratogens. Week 3: heart. Week 8: resembles human.

Fetus (2 months→birth): Weeks 13–16: lanugo, brain waves. 21–24: quickening. 25–28: may survive. 38: full term (7–8 lbs).

Environmental Influences

Mother's diseases (rubella) · Drugs/alcohol (FAS) · Radiation · Age (>35 risk) · Nutrition (1st trimester critical) · Stress (hormones cross placenta) · **Rh incompatibility** (erythroblastosis).

Infancy (Birth–2 years)

Erikson: Trust vs. Mistrust 3M

Trust → feeling safe/secure. Mistrust → inconsistent/rejecting caregivers. Virtue: **hope**.

Attachment 3M

Ainsworth et al. (1978): emotionally toned relationship. Indiscriminate attachment early.

Separation anxiety · **Stranger anxiety**.

Motor Development 6M

Gross motor (large muscles: crawling, walking) learnt **before** fine motor (small muscles: writing). **Sensitive period** = time when specific activity learnt most effectively. Not force writing before 4.5–5.5 yrs.

6 basic behaviours: Running · Jumping · Sequencing · Balancing · Throwing · Catching.

Language Development 6M

4 components: Phonology · Semantics · Grammar (syntax+morphology) · Pragmatics.

Cooing (~2 mo) → Babbling (~4 mo) → First words (~12 mo) → Telegraphic speech (~18 mo).

Fast mapping · **Vocabulary spurt** (18–24 mo) · Over/under-extensions.

Early Childhood (2–6 years)

Piaget: Pre-operational Stage 10M

4 stages: **Sensorimotor** (0–2) → **Pre-operational** (2–7) → **Concrete operational** (7–11) →

Formal operational (11+).

Key concepts: **schemas** **assimilation** **accommodation** **egocentrism** **conservation**

decentration **reversibility** **horizontal décalage**

Sensori-Motor Sub-stages 3M

(1) Reflexes (0–1 mo) · (2) Primary Circular Reactions (1–4 mo) · (3) Secondary Circular

Reactions (4–8 mo) · (4) Coordination (8–12 mo) · (5) Tertiary Circular Reactions (12–24 mo) ·

(6) Early Representational Thought.

Object permanence at ~7 months.

Characteristics & Hazards 6M

Toy age · Play age · School going age. Behavioural problems: obstinacy, stubbornness, negativistic.

Physical hazards: Illness · Accidents (boys > girls) · Obesity.

Psychological hazards: Speech · Social · Play · Moral hazards.

Height & Weight Factors 3M

7 factors (Hurlock, 1978): Family · Nutrition · Emotional disturbances · SES · Health ·

Endocrine (dwarfism/giantism) · Sex.

Body types: endomorphic · mesomorphic · ectomorphic.

Growth: 2–2.5 in + 3–6 lbs/year.

Emotional Patterns 3M

Fear (shift typical→general; shyness) · **Anxiety** (develops later; increases 4th–6th grade) ·

Anger (impulsive vs. inhibited responses) · **Curiosity** ("questioning age") · **Joy** (success most pleasant).

Emotional tolerance = accept unpleasant experiences. Erikson: **Autonomy vs. Shame & Doubt**.

School-Age (6–11 years)

Social Development 10M

Parents: Role → consultants. Mothers preferred; fathers encourage independence.

Siblings: Teach/help; practice social skills.

Peers: Gender segregation (6–9) → crowds/cliques (9–12). Conformity peak grades 8–9.

Popularity: sociable, cooperative, assertive.

Grammar & Semantics 3M

Vocab expansion 6–12. Language difficulties → aggressive behaviour (Burke et al., 1989).

Communication effectiveness develops with cognitive/overall development.

Learning to Write 3M

Handwriting improves 6–11 yrs. Eye-hand coordination: age 8 = better planning; age 10 = speed/direction control (Bairstow, 1989). Girls greater dexterity.

Value Education 6M

Develop moral reasoning, empathy, character. Methods: storytelling, role-playing, group discussions, community service.

Educational excursions: experiential learning, real-world connections, motivation.